be applicable to the Kachin context, the identification of 'strategic sites' is helpful for providing a method for the examination of the connection between women's access to productive resources, gender-based inequality in socio-economic and political spheres, and gender-based violence. In the context of Kachin State, this helps to highlight the relationship between women's vulnerability to violence and macro-level poverty in conflict-affected areas. For instance, increased material insecurity as a result of the conflict has been accompanied by a rise in the level of women trafficked abroad and by the number of rape cases reported (see Table 4.2). According to local women's groups, in the first two months of the renewed conflict, thirty-seven women and young girls were sexually abused; thirteen of these were killed (KWAT 2013a). Thus, this method allows analysis of the relationship between a gendered division of labour and experiences of gendered insecurities to contextualize women's motivations to join or support the KIO/KIA.

Table 4.2. Reports of conflict-related gender-based violence in Kachin State

Type	Source	Year	Reports
Sexual violence	Kachin Women's Association Thailand 2011	2011	37
Sexual violence	Quintana 2011	2011	18
Sexual violence	Women's League of Burma 2014	2011–14	59
Trafficking	Kachin Women Association Thailand 2013	2011–13	24
Sexual violence	Ban 2012	2011	32
Sexual violence	Lee 2015a, 2015b	2015	2

It is to these sites that I will now turn, analysing them in the context of political and macroeconomic processes that not only detrimentally impact women's insecurity, but also sustain the conflict. In particular, I will highlight four strategic sites of relevance to Kachin State: the relationship between poverty, political participation, and gender-based violence in conflict areas, and in internally displaced persons communities; the relationship between gender insecurity, participation in social reproduction, and political activities in the army; and the relationship between gender insecurity and sexual and gender-based violence within the state.